MIL-D-46653B (MU)
29 October 1973
SUPERSEDING
MIL-D-46653A (MU)
1 July 1965 and
MIL-D-46645A (MU)
1 July 1965
(see 6.6)

# MILITARY SPECIFICATION
# DETONATOR, M31A1
# PARTS FOR, AND LOADING, ASSEMBLING AND PACKING

## 1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers the parts for, loading, assembling and packing for one type detonator designated as Detonator M31A1.

## 2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-P-116 - Preservation, Methods of
MIL-A-2550 - Ammunition and Special Weapons; General Specification for

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes (ABC-STD-105)
MIL-STD-109 - Quality Assurance Terms and Definitions
MIL-STD-650 - Explosives: Sampling, Inspection and Testing

FSC: 1375

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MIL-STD-1168 - Lot Numbering of Ammunition
MIL-STD-1235 - Single and Multilevel Continuous Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

DRAWINGS

US ARMY ARMAMENTS COMMAND

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 7548244 | - | Detonator, M31A1, Assembly |
| 8816367 | - | Holder, Firing Pin |
| 8816368 | - | Disc |
| 8827934 | - | Adapter Ball |
| 8868623 | - | Set Up Assembly |
| 8867811 | - | Holder Primer |
| 9200012 | - | Firing Pin |
| 9200602 | - | Bushing |
| 9258182 | - | Box, Set-up, Packing, Ammunition, Inner, for small explosive components |
| 9258183 | - | Box, Set-up Packing, Ammunition, Outer for small explosive components |
| 9258184 | - | Box Packing, Ammunition for Small Explosive Components |

(Copies of specifications, standards, and drawings required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.-Materials shall be in accordance with applicable drawings and specifications.

3.2 Detonator assembly.-The detonator assembly shall comply with all requirements specified on Drawing (dwg.) 7548244 and with all requirements specified in applicable specifications.

3.3 Moisture content.

3.3.1 Lead azide.-The moisture content of the lead azide used in loading the detonators shall not exceed 0.50 percent.



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3.3.2 Ignition mixture.The moisture content of the ignition mixture used in loading the detonators shall not exceed 0.30 percent.

3.4 Functioning.The detonator shall function on the first attempt under a maximum (max) applied energy of 31.60 inch ounces and shall cause a .3125 inch minimum (min) diameter perforation in a .134 - .003 inch thick lead disc.

3.5 Workmanship.All parts and assemblies shall be fabricated and loaded in a thorough, workmanlike manner. They shall be free of burrs, sharp edges, cracks, dirt, corrosion products and other foreign matter. The cleaning method used shall not be injurious to any part nor shall the parts be contaminated by the cleaning agent. Exterior surface coatings shall be continuous except for a few light scratches not exposing base material. All required markings shall be neat and sharply defined.

3.6 First Article Inspection.This specification makes provisions for first article inspection. Requirements for the submission of first article samples by the contractor shall be as specified in the contract.

## 4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for Inspection.-Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements. Reference shall be made to MIL-STD-109 to define terms used herein. The provisions of MIL-A-2550 shall apply.

4.1.1 Submission of Product.-At the time each completed lot of items deliverable under the contract is submitted to the Government for acceptance, the contractor shall supply the following information accompanied by a certificate which attests that the information provided is correct and applicable to the product being submitted.

a. A statement that the lot complies with all of the quality assurance provisions specified in this specification.



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b. Drawing and specification number and date, together with identification and date of changes thereto.

c. A statement that all material purchased by the contractor meets requirements, when such material is controlled by Government or commercial specifications referenced in any of the contractual documents, and that certificates of conformance are on file and available for review.

d. Number of items in the lot.

e. Date submitted.

The certificate shall be signed by a responsible agent of the certifying organization. The initial certificate submitted shall be substantiated by evidence of the agent's authority to bind his principal. Substantiation of the agents authority will not be required with subsequent certificates unless, during the course of the contract, this authority is vested in another agent of the certifying organization.

4.2.1 Submission.-Prior to the start of regular production the contractor shall submit a first article sample (see 6.1c) to a Government approved facility as designated by the contracting officer for evaluation in accordance with the provisions of 4.2.2 and 4.2.3. The first article sample shall consist of 50 complete sets of parts (i.e., 50 each of every component which have been produced by the contractor or furnished by a supplier and which have been manufactured using the same production processes, procedures and equipment which will be used in fulfilling the contract. All parts and materials including packaging and packing shall be obtained from the same source of supply as will be used in regular production. Prior to submission, the contractor shall inspect the sample to the degree necessary to assure that it conforms to the requirements of the contract and submit a record of this inspection with the sample, including a certificate of conformance for materials. A sample containing known defects will not be submitted unless specifically authorized by the Contracting Officer. A first article sample, or portion thereof, as directed by the contracting officer, shall also be submitted whenever there is a lapse in production for a period in excess of 90 days or whenever a change occurs in manufacturing process, material used, drawing or specification such as to significantly affect product uniformity as determined by the Government.

4.2.2 Inspections to be performed.-Components will be subjected by the Government to any or all of the examinations specified in this specification and any or all requirements of the applicable drawings.



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4.2.3 Rejection.-If any component fails to comply with the applicable requirements, the first article sample shall be rejected. In the event of rejection, the Government reserves the right to require the contractor to take corrective action and submit a new first article sample or portion thereof. Until a first article sample is accepted, the contractor is, in no way, authorized by the Government to initiate regular production unless otherwise directed by the contracting officer.

4.3 Inspection provisions

4.3.1 Lot formation.-The term "inspection lot" as used in this specification is defined as an essentially homogeneous collection of units of product from which a representative sample is drawn and inspected to determine conformance with applicable requirements. The sample selected shall represent only that quantity of units from which the sample was drawn and shall not be construed to represent any prior or subsequent quantities presented for inspection. Homogeneity shall be considered to exist provided the inspection lot has been produced by one manufacturer in one unchanged process using the same materials and methods in accordance with the same drawings, same drawing revisions, same specifications and same specification revisions and complies with the provisions for submission of product as specified in MIL-STD-105. Changes to the process, specifications, or drawings not affecting safety, performance, interchangeability, or storage, as determined by the Government, shall not be deemed to alter the homogeneity of an inspection lot. All material submitted for inspection in accordance with this specification shall comply with the homogeneity criteria specified herein regardless of the type of sampling procedure which is being applied to determine conformance with requirements. Lot numbering, as required, shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-1168. Each inspection lot of loaded detonator assemblies shall contain:

a. Parts from one lot interfix number from one manufacturer.

b. Tetryl from not more than one lot.

c. Lead azide of the same type from not more than two lots produced by the same manufacturer in accordance with the same specification and same specification revision and which have subsequently been subjected to uniformly controlled drying and operating conditions at the loading plant.

d. Ignition mixture from one batch or blending of batches, that results in homogeneity of all ignition mixtures used in loading the entire detonator lot.



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4.3.2 Examination.-The examinations listed in the following subparagraphs shall be performed on inspection lots (see 4.3.1) of the components or assemblies designated in the applicable paragraph headings. Inspection for critical defects (and major defects, when so specified) shall be 100 percent. Sampling plans for major and minor defects shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 except that continuous sampling plans in accordance with MIL-STD-1235 may be used if approved by the Government. Instead of applying the AQL's designated herein to the groups of major and minor defects listed, the contractor may elect to apply AQL's to individual defects using an AQL of 0.40 percent for each major defect and an AQL of 0.65 percent for each minor defect. When this method is elected, it shall be applied to all of the major and minor defects listed in the applicable subparagraphs of this section, except where 100 percent inspection is specified, and be documented as part of the contractor's inspection system. Equipment necessary for the performance of the inspections listed shall be in accordance with 4.3.4.

4.3.2.1 Disc, detonator closing (see dwg. 9283129 covering a detail of dwg. 7548244).

| Categories | Defects | Method of Inspection | Cde No. (see 6.2) |
|---|---|---|---|
| Critical: None defined. | | | |
| Major: | AQL 0.40 percent | | |
| 101. | Diameter | Gage | 01001 |
| 102. | Thickness | Gage | 01002 |
| Minor: | AQL 0.65 percent | | |
| 201. | Evidence of poor workmanship, (see 3.5) | Visual | 01003 |

4.3.2.2 Disc, detonator (see dwg. 9283128 covering a detail of dwg. 7548244).

| Categories | Defects | Method of Inspection | Code No. |
|---|---|---|---|
| Critical: None defined. | | | |



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| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Major: | AQL 0.40 percent | | |
| 101. | Diameter | Gage | 02001 |
| 102. | Thickness | Gage | 02002 |
| Minor: | AQL 0.65 percent | | |
| 201. | Evidence of poor workmanship, (see 3.5) | Visual | 02003 |

4.3.2.3 Cup, detonator (see dwg. 9283127 covering a detail of dwg. 7548244).

| Categories | Defects | Method of Inspection | Code No. |
|---|---|---|---|
| Critical: | None defined. | | |
| Major: | AQL 1.00 percent | | |
| 101. | Outside diameter, max | Gage | 03001 |
| 102. | Diameter of flash hole, min | Gage | 03002 |
| 103. | Concentricity of flash hole with outside diameter | Gage | 03003 |
| 104. | Thickness through bottom, min | Gage | 03004 |
| 105. | Total length | Gage | 03005 |
| Minor: | AQL 0.65 percent | | |
| 201. | Inside diameter, min | Gage | 03006 |
| 202. | Evidence of poor workmanship, (see 3.5) | Visual | 03007 |

4.3.2.4 Assembly, prior to loading and closing (see dwg. 7548244).

| Categories | Defects | Method of Inspection | Code No. |
|---|---|---|---|
| Critical: | | | |
| 1. | Interior coating incomplete or inadequate | Visual | 04001 |
| Major: | None defined. | | |
| Minor: | AQL 0.65 percent | | |
| 201. | Evidence of poor workmanship, (see 3.5) | Visual | 04002 |



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4.3.2.5 Detonator assembly (see dwg. 7548244).

| Categories | Defects | Method of Inspection | Code No. |
|---|---|---|---|
| Critical: | | | |
| 1. | Cup split or cracked | Visual | 05001 |
| Major: | AQL 1.00 percent | | |
| 101. | Total length | Gage | 05002 |
| 102. | Diameter | Gage | 05003 |
| 103. | Color of disc improper | Visual | 05004 |
| 104. | Not crimped full 360 degrees | Visual | 05005 |
| 105. | Disc punctured or torn | Visual | 05006 |
| 106. | Lacquer seal incomplete or inadequate | Visual | 05007 |
| Minor: | AQL 0.65 percent | | |
| 201. | Evidence of poor workmanship, (see 3.5) | Visual | 05008 |

4.3.2.6 Box, set-up inner, after loading and prior to closing slide cover (see dwg. 9258182).

| Categories | Defects | Method of Inspection | Code No. |
|---|---|---|---|
| Critical: | | | |
| 1. | Filler and cushion assembly missing | Visual | 06001 |
| 2. | Filler and cushion assembly improperly assembled | Visual | 06002 |
| 3. | Stiffener missing | Visual | 06003 |
| 4. | Slide cover assembled reversed | Visual | 06004 |
| Major: | AQL 0.40 percent | | |
| 101. | Release paper missing | Visual | 06005 |
| Minor: | AQL 1.00 percent | | |
| 201. | Marking missing, incomplete or illegible | Visual | 06006 |
| 202. | Evidence of poor workmanship, (see 3.5) | Visual | 06007 |



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4.3.2.7 Box, set-up outer, with inner set-up boxes assembled and prior to assembling top and sealing strip (see dwg. 9258183).

| Categories | Defects | Method of Inspection | Code No. |
|---|---|---|---|
| Critical: | | | |
| 1. | Red surfaces on inner set-up boxes do not alternate on same side of outer set-up box | Visual | 07001 |
| 2. | Stiffener not facing one direction | Visual | 07002 |
| Major: None defined. | | | |
| Minor: | AQL 1.00 percent | | |
| 201. | Marking missing, incomplete or illegible | Visual | 07003 |
| 202. | Evidence of poor workmanship, (see 3.5) | Visual | 07004 |

4.3.2.8 Box, packing, ammunition prior to assembling cover and strapping (see dwg. 9258184).

| Categories | Defects | Method of Inspection | Code No. |
|---|---|---|---|
| Critical: None defined. | | | |
| Major: | AQL 0.40 percent | | |
| 101. | Bags containing set-up boxes damaged | Visual | 08001 |
| 102. | Cushioning material incomplete or missing from around outer set-up boxes | Visual | 08002 |
| Minor: | AQL 0.65 percent | | |
| 201. | Evidence of poor workmanship, (see 3.5) | Visual | 08003 |

4.3.2.9 Box, packing, ammunition (see dwg. 9258184).



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| Categories | Defects | Method of Inspection | Code No. |
|---|---|---|---|
| Critical: | None defined. | | |
| Major: | AQL 0.65 percent | | |
| 101. | Strapping missing, broken, loose or improperly fastened..... | Visual/ Manual | 09001 |
| 102. | Box damaged..... | Visual | 09002 |
| 103. | Marking missing, broken or illegible..... | Visual | 09003 |
| Minor: | AQL 0.65 percent | | |
| 201. | Evidence of poor workmanship, (see 3.5)..... | Visual | 09004 |

4.3.3 Testing

4.3.3.1 Moisture content (see 3.3) Major defect.-The contractor shall provide adequate controls to insure compliance with the requirements, and shall test for verification, at least one sample of lead azide, (Code No. 10001), and one sample of ignition mixture (Code No. 10002) from each eight hours production of detonators. Composite samples shall not be used. The tests shall be performed as specified in 4.4.1.

4.3.3.2 Functioning (see 3.4) - Major defect - Code No. 05009.-A sample of 315 detonators shall be selected at random from each lot. If 3 or more detonators fail to comply with the requirement specified, the lot shall be rejected. If one or two defects are found, a second sample of 315 shall be selected at random and tested. If, in the combined first and second sample, a total of 4 or more defects are found, the lot shall be rejected. The test shall be performed as specified in 4.4.2.

4.3.3.3 Graphite content of tetryl (see dwg. 7548244) - Major defect - Code No. 10003.-The graphite content of each lot of tetryl shall be determined at the time of loading. A sample, of sufficient size to perform the test specified in 4.4.3, shall be selected for the determination. If the graphite content is in excess of the specified percentage, and loading has not begun, the lot shall be rejected. If detonator loading is in progress, the remaining unloaded tetryl in the lot and all the detonators loaded with the non-conforming tetryl shall be rejected.



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4.3.3.4 Composition of ignition mixture (see dwg. 7548244) - Major defect - Code No. 10004.-The composition of each lot of ignition mixture shall be determined at the time of loading. A sample of sufficient size to perform the test specified in 4.4.4 shall be selected for the determination. If the composition of the ignition mixture does not conform with the dwg. requirements, rejection shall be as specified in 4.3.3.3.

4.3.3.5 Heat seal test of sealed bag (see dwg. 9258183) Major defect - Code No. 07005.-Sampling, acceptance criteria and test procedures for this test shall be as specified in Specification MIL-P-116.

4.3.4 Inspection equipment.-Inspection equipment required to perform the inspection prescribed in this specification is identified in the Examination (4.3.2) and Test Method (4.4) paragraphs herein. See 6.3 for details concerning responsibilities for inspection equipment design and approval.

4.4 Test methods and procedures.

4.4.1 Moisture content.

4.4.1.1 Moisture content of lead azide.-The moisture content of the lead azide shall be determined in accordance with MIL-STD-650, Method 101.5 excpt, use a two gram sample and cover the dish with a sheet of polytetrafluoroethylene.

4.4.1.2 Ignition mixture.-The moisture content of the ignition mixture shall be determined as specified in 4.4.1.1 except that the drying temperature shall be 60 plus or minus 5 degrees C. and only 0.40 to 0.70 grams of ignition mixture shall be dried.

4.4.2 Functioning.-The detonator shall be assembled to the applicable test fixture. A steel ball 1-3/16 inch in diameter and weighing 3.95 ounces, max., shall be dropped on the firing pin from a height of 8 inches, max., to function an M55 Primer which shall initiate the detonator. The height of the drop shall be measured as the height from the top of the firing pin to the bottom of the ball. A detonator that fails to fire or fails to create a hole in the lead disc of the required size shall be classed defective. Method of inspection shall be in accordance with dwgs. 8816367, 8816368, 8827934, 8868623, 8867811, 9200012 and 9200602.



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4.4.3 Graphite content of tetryl.-An accurately weighed portion of approximately 5 grams shall be transferred to a tared medium porosity sintered glass filtering crucible. The sample shall be extracted with four 10 milliliter (ml) portions of acetone maintaining each portion in contact with the residue for approximately 5 minutes before applying suction. Any lumps which may persist shall be broken up and the sides of the crucible washed down with each 10 ml. portion of acetone to insure complete removal of the tetryl. The residue shall be aspirated until the odor of acetone is no longer detectable. The crucible and contents shall be placed in a drying oven at 100 degrees Centigrade (C.) for 1/2 hours, cooled in a desiccator and weighed. The above extractions shall be repeated, drying and weighing with each individual 10 ml. portions of acetone until the loss in weight on subsequent extractions totals less than 0.005 grams. The weight of residue in the crucible shall be calculated as the percentage of graphite in the tetryl.

4.4.4 Composition of ignition mixture.

4.4.4.1 Lead sulfocyanate.-An accurately weighed portion of approximately 1 gram of the sample, after drying as specified in 4.4.1.2 shall be transferred to a 250 ml. beaker. Twenty ml. of distilled water shall be added and stirred with a rubber policeman until the sample is thoroughly wetted. Exactly 35 ml. of standardized 0.1N silver nitrate solution shall be added. One hundred ml. of 10 percent nitric acid aolution shall be added while stirring the mixture. (Nitric acids should be water-white and free of oxides of nitrogen). The mixture shall be stirred thoroughly for 5 minutes and then 5 ml. of saturated solution of ferric ammonium sulfate shall be added. The resulting mixture shall be titrated with standardized 0.1N potassium sulfocyanate solution to the first permanent pale rose coloration. The percentage of lead sulfocyanate shall be calculated as follows:

Percentage of lead sulfocyanate = (35 A-BC times 16.17) divided by W

Where:

A = normality of silver nitrate solution
B = volume in ml. of 0.1N potassium sulfocyanate solution
C = normality of 0.1N potassium sulfocyanate solution
W = weight of moisture free sample



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4.4.4.2 Potassium chlorate.-The percentage of potassium chlorate shall be determined by subtracting the percentage of lead sulfocyanate from 100.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation and packaging

5.1.1 Level C.-Packaging shall be as specified on dwgs. 9258182 and 9258183.

5.2 Packing

5.2.1 Level C.-Packing shall be as specified on dwg. 9258184.

5.3 Marking.-Marking of all packaging and packing shall comply with dwg. 9258182, 9258183 and 9258184.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data.-Procurement documents shall specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Data cards.-Data cards shall be prepared for each lot in accordance with the information specified in Standard MIL-STD-1167.
c. Provisions for submission of first article samples.

6.2 Inspection code numbers.-The five digit code numbers assigned to the inspections herein are to facilitate future data collection and analysis by the Government. They should be cited as references on drawings of equipment designs submitted by the contractor to the Government for approval (see 6.3.3).

6.3 Inspection Equipment Designs.-Inspection equipment designs are of two types - Government Special Inspection Equipment (SIE) designs and contractor designs. SIE designs are designated by drawing numbers (under the "Method of Inspection" headings in Section 4). Design responsibility for all other inspection equipment is assigned to the contractor. The contractor need not furnish any design when a complete Government SIE design is provided. Unless otherwise specified, however, the contractor may submit alternate or modified contractor designs of SIE in accordance with 6.3.2 and 6.3.3 should he elect to do so.



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6.3.1 SIE designs.-SIE designs may consist of any of the following:

a. Detailed drawings which completely depict all information necessary for the fabrication and use of the item of inspection equipment.

b. A source control drawing or a specification control drawing as defined in MIL-STD-100.

c. An envelope drawing, as defined in MIL-STD-100, which establishes the criteria which a detail design shall meet. When envelope drawings are specified, the contractor shall prepare designs which comply with the criteria therein.

6.3.2 Contractor designs.-Contractor designs are required for all inspection equipment for which SIE designs are not specified and may include commercial equipment which the contractor proposes to use.(C(Commercial equipment is defined as unmodified equipment which is cataloged and available for purchase by the general public). Contractor designs shall include appropriate operating instructions, calibration procedures and maintenance procedures. Commercial equipment shall be fully described by catalog listings or other means which provide sufficient information to permit identification and evaluation by the Government and may include illustrations and engineering data. Designs shall be prepared for any special fixture(s) required to be used with commercial equipment, or with SIE designs if not otherwise covered thereby (see 6.3.1c). Designs shall be of the category and form (per MIL-D-1000) specified in the Contract Data Requirements Lists (DD Form 1423). The contractor is referred to MIL-HDBK-204, "Inspection Equipment Design" for guidance. The specification number and the applicable five-digit defect code number (or other specific identifying information) from Section 4 of this specification shall be referenced on each contractor design together with the component or assembly drawing number and revision letter to which the specific design applies.

6.3.3 Submission of designs for approval.-Contractor designs shall be approved by the Government prior to fabriacting or procuring the equipment. Designs shall be submitted for approval to Picatinny Arsenal, ATTN: SARPA-QA-A-M, Dover, New Jersey 07801 in accordance with the stipulations, time frame and distribution specified in the Contract Data Requirements List (DD Form 423) or in the contract. The contractor must include in his submission of designs a listing of any and all Government SIE designs which will be utilized. Partial submission of inspection equipment



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designs is permissible and encouraged. However, the completion date for design review will be based on the date of the final submission of designs. Picatinny Arsenal design review will normally be accomplished within one month after receipt.

6.4 Submission of test data and ammunition data cards.-In addition to the normal distribution of records, for loaded items procured by the Department of the Army, one copy of all ballistic test data and ammunition data cards shall be forwarded to the following:

Commander
Picatinny Arsenal
ATTN: SARPA-QA-A-M
SARPA-ADEP-2
Dover, New Jersey 07801

6.5 Check test for possible deterioration.-The following test is designed to prevent major ammunition items being loaded with detonators that may have deteriorated. This test shall be performed on detonators from each lot which has been stored under normal conditions for more than two years, or under adverse conditions for any period of time. If the specification for the ammunition item into which the detonators are loaded does not require a check test, the contracting officer shall insert into the contract a check test performance provision. The contracting officer will arrange for the contractor to be reimbursed for expenses incurred in the performance of the deterioration check test.

6.5.1 Functioning.-A sample of 315 detonators shall be selected at random from each lot. If 4 or more detonators fail to comply with the requirement specified, the lot shall be rejected. If more than one defect is found, a second sample of 315 shall be selected at random and tested. If in the combined first and second sample a total of 5 or more defects are found, the lot shall be rejected. The test shall be performed as specified in 4.4.2.

6.6 Supersession data.-This specification includes the requirements of MIL-D-46645A (MU), dated 1 July 1965.

Custodian:
Army-MU

Preparing Activity:
Army-MU

Project Number: 1375-A-046



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